BY ORDER OF THE
SECRETARY OF THE AIR FORCE

HEADQUARTERS MISSION
DIRECTIVE 1-36

12 MAY 2026

Special Management

DIRECTOR OF AIR FORCE HISTORY AND MUSEUMS POLICIES AND PROGRAMS

COMPLIANCE WITH THIS PUBLICATION IS MANDATORY

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SUMMARY OF CHANGES

This mission directive has been revised to reflect the functional transfer of the Air Force Art Program from SAF/AM and expanded Special Access Program collection policy and guidance.

1. Mission. Pursuant to Title 10 United States Code (USC) §§ 9013 and 9031, the Secretary of the Air Force (SecAF) may establish offices and officials within the Air Staff to assist the SecAF in carrying out his/her responsibilities. Consistent with 10 USC §§ 9013 and 9031, and as documented by **paragraph 4.3**. of Air Force Mission Directive (AFMD) 1, *Headquarters Air Force*, and this Headquarters Air Force Mission Directive (HAFMD), there is a Director of Air Force History and Museums Policies and Programs (AF/HO) for the Air Force and Space Force and is part of the Air Staff. The Secretary of the Air Force (SecAF) retains ultimate responsibility for all DAF policies. Within their areas of responsibility, the AF/HO prepares detailed instructions for the execution of approved plans, supervises the execution of those plans and instructions, prepares policies for approval and issues guidance/procedures, via official DAF level publications, to ensure implementation of those policies. The AF/HO also assists the Chief of Staff of the Air Force (CSAF) and Chief of Space Operations (CSO) in their role, pursuant to 10 USC § 151, as a member of the Joint Chiefs of Staff (JCS).

2. Organizational Relationships. Subject only to the authority, direction, and control of the Secretary of Defense (referred to as Secretary of War (SecWar)), the SecAF is responsible for, and has all legal authority necessary to conduct, the affairs of the DAF. The Office of the Secretary of the Air Force (Secretariat), Air Staff and the Office of the Chief of Space Operations (known as the Space Staff) perform their DAF functions subject to the authority, direction, and control of the SecAF.

2.1. The AF/HO furnishes professional assistance to the SecAF, the Under Secretary of the Air Force, the Assistant Secretaries of the Air Force and reports directly to the CSAF and is answerable to the CSO for Space Force history matters. The Headquarters U.S. Air Force Director of Staff (AF/DS) provides supervision on policy and management matters. The SecAF may re-delegate authority/assign responsibility to the AF/HO, but the SecAF, through CSAF and CSO, and, as appropriate, Assistant Secretaries of the Air Force, retains ultimate responsibility for all matters listed in **Attachment 1** of this publication.

2.2. The AF/HO is part of the Air Staff and as such works closely with other HAF offices to assist the SecAF, the CSAF, and the CSO in carrying out their responsibilities. The AF/HO and the Office of the AF/HO work in cooperation with other Headquarters Department of the Air Force (HQ DAF) organizations, which are responsible, pursuant to Chapters **903**, **905**, and **908** of Title 10, for assisting the SecAF, the CSAF, and the CSO in carrying out their responsibilities.

2.3. Reporting to the AF/HO is a Field Operating Agency, the Air Force Historical Research Agency (AFHRA), whose mission is documented in AFMD 30, *Air Force Historical Research Agency*.

3. Responsibilities. The AF/HO is specifically responsible for:

3.1. Establishing policy and guidance for and directing the operations necessary to create and preserve a thorough record of DAF institutions and activities.

3.2. Establishing policy for and directing the establishment and operations of command and other field history programs.

3.3. Overseeing compilation of the annual history of HQ DAF and other historical services as required.

3.4. Ensuring the establishment and efficient operation of an archival operation to preserve DAF historical documents and provide research assistance to those researching those documents.

3.5. Establishing policy and guidance for and directing the operations of the Air Force Historical Research Agency.

3.6. Establishing guidance for and broad oversight of the oral history, end of tour reports, and personal papers programs.

3.7. Preparing guidance for document disposition to ensure important historical materials are preserved.

3.8. Preparing guidance for operational documentation held by the Air Force History and Museums Programs.

3.9. Establishing policy and directing operations for digital preservation and curation within the Air Force History and Museums Program, including ensuring long-term access and integrity of born-digital and digitized records; developing workflows for appraisal, ingest, metadata, and lifecycle management; implementing protocols for redundancy, format migration, and authenticity; and promoting ethical, context-sensitive stewardship of historical digital assets.

3.10. Providing guidance and policy to the National Museum of the United States Air Force and the other museums and components of the Air Force Museum System and Heritage Program.

3.11. Providing guidance and policy for the Department of the Air Force Art Program.

3.12. Providing guidance for historical documentation of Sensitive Activities operations and programs and other classified subjects conducted in compliance with established security policy and standards.

3.13. Serving as Chairman of the Air Force History and Museums Civilian Career Program.

3.14. Serving as the Air Force History and Museums Program Career Field Manager and Development Team Lead.

3.15. Planning, programming, budgeting, and allocating resources for the Air Force Historical Support Office (AF/HOH), the Space History Division (AF/HOS), the AFHRA, and program-wide activities including the initial and continuing training of personnel within the Air Force History and Museums Program.

3.16. Maintaining relationships with the history programs of the other military services, other United States government agencies, and appropriate foreign government organizations.

3.17. Representing the DAF at meetings of historical and other learned societies to encourage interest by educational and professional institutions in military aerospace history, subject to the availability of funding.

3.18. Preparing guidance, in cooperation with the Deputy Chief of Staff for Manpower, Personnel, and Services (AF/A1), for managing historians, archivists, and curators working within the Air Force History and Museums Program.

4. Delegations of Secretary of the Air Force Authority and Assignments of Responsibility: **Attachment 1** lists authorities delegated and responsibilities assigned by SecAF to the AF/HO. The authorities delegated/responsibilities assigned to the AF/HO by this HAFMD may be re-delegated or reassigned to a subordinate official, unless re-delegation is expressly prohibited by the attached delegation or by controlling law, regulation, or Department of Defense (referred to as the Department of War (DoW)) issuance. While the authorities are delegated and responsibilities assigned to the AF/HO, the exercise of the authorities/responsibilities remain subject to the oversight and control of the SecAF, any Assistant Secretary of the Air Force having oversight, the CSAF, and the CSO. Any re-delegation of authority/reassignment of responsibility shall not be effective unless it is in writing, has been reviewed by both the General Counsel of the DAF (SAF/GC) as chief legal officer and the Judge Advocate General (AF/JA) for complementary legal services, and is signed by the AF/HO. Any person re-delegating authorities in accordance with this directive may further restrict or condition the authority/ responsibility being re-delegated/re-assigned.

5. Continuation of Prior Re-Delegations of Authority/Assignments of Responsibility: Re-delegations of authority/assignments of responsibility made prior to the date of issuance in this HAFMD remain effective insofar as such re-delegations are not inconsistent with the terms of this HAFMD, unless superseded by new issuances.

Troy E. Meink
Secretary of the Air Force

Attachment 1

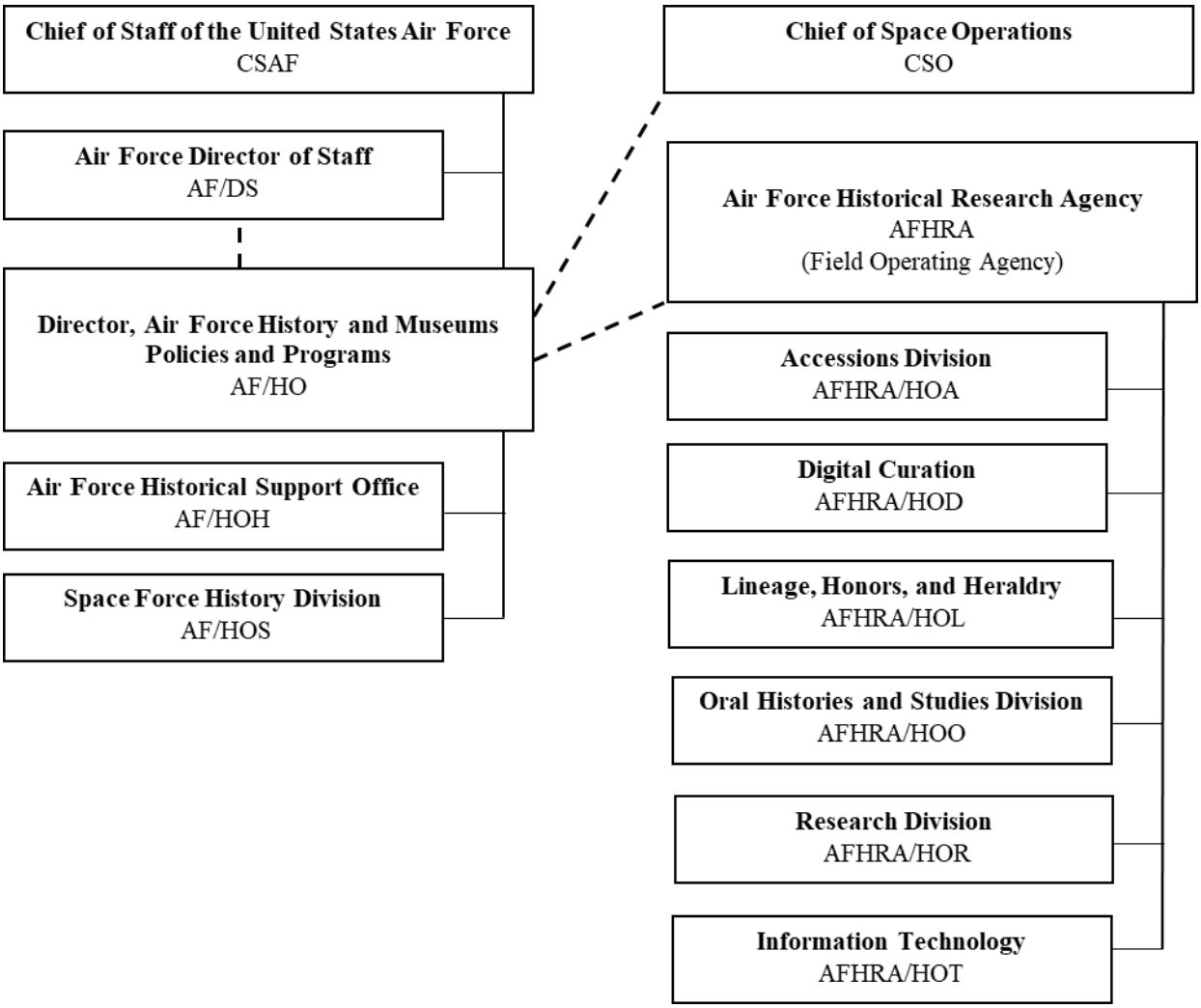
DELEGATIONS OF SECRETARY OF THE AIR FORCE AUTHORITY/ASSIGNMENTS OF RESPONSIBILITY TO THE DIRECTOR, AIR FORCE HISTORY AND MUSEMS POLICIES AND PROGRAMS

There are no delegations documented at this time.

Attachment 2

DIRECTOR, AIR FORCE HISTORY AND MUSEUMS POLICIES AND PROGRAMS (AF/HO)

Figure A2.1. Organizational Chart.



The dotted line to AFHRA represents AF/HO's responsibility for administrative guidance and oversight. The dotted line to AF/HO represents AF/DS's supervision on policy and management matters. The dotted line to CSO represents AF/HO's support for Space Force history and museum matters.

A2.1. The Director, Air Force History and Museums Policies and Programs is responsible for providing professional assistance for all matters pertaining to Air Force policies and standards for historical products and services; management oversight to its subordinate divisions, the Air Force Historical Support Office (AF/HOH) and the Space History Division (AF/HOS), and its field operating agency, the Air Force Historical Research Agency (AFHRA); and furnishing guidance and policy for the Air Force Museum and Heritage Program.

A2.2. 3-Letter subordinate offices include:

A2.2.1. The Air Force Historical Support Office (AF/HOH). AF/HOH is responsible for matters pertaining to the preparation of the annual Air Staff History; and providing historical support to Headquarters Air Force, the DoW, other government offices and agencies, and Congress.

A2.2.2. The Space History Division (AF/HOS). AF/HOS is responsible for matters pertaining to the preparation of the annual Space Staff History; and providing historical support to Headquarters Air Force, the DoW, other government offices and agencies, and Congress.

A2.2.3. The Accessions Division (AFHRA/HOA) oversees the addition of incoming material to the AFHRA's collection, creates metadata for the Digital Asset Management System (DAMS), creates microform records, migrates various forms of media, and digitizes analog records.

A2.2.4. The Digital Curation Division (AFHRA/HOD) is responsible for the digital curation of all DAF digital archival data, producing detailed policies, procedures, and functional area expertise to entire program DAFHMP on digital archives. It produces narrative responses to official inquiries from Congress, DAF (and its staff components), Air Staff, Space Staff, Major Commands, Field Commands, Air University, DAF field history program offices as it relates to digital curation and digital archival theory for services across a wide spectrum. Additionally, the Digital Curation Division acts as the AFHRA digital interface with all entities (official and public) as it relates to the vast repository of digital archival collections resident within the agency and the front facing cloud-based platforms. The work the Digital Curation Division serves customers world-wide, from the highest to lowest echelons of the DAF, other armed services, veterans, and public.

A2.2.5. The Lineage, Honors and Heraldry Division (AFHRA/HOL) is responsible for five major tasks in support of the USAF and the USSF: (1) maintain primary source documents and organizational data on all active, inactive, and disbanded Army Air Forces and DAF units from pre-WW I through present; (2) determine and provide units with official Lineage and Honors (L&H) histories; (3) process and approve heraldry for newly constituted units and for units with no heraldry on file; (4) answer official and unofficial requests for unit history and heritage information, including aerial victory credits; and (5) develop monthly USAF and USSF organizational status change reports, USAF and USSF biannual lists of active units, and annual Air Force heritage score reports.

A2.2.6. The Oral Histories and Studies Division (AFHRA/HOO) is responsible for identifying, researching, writing, and publishing timely special historical studies and monographs that aid the DAF in its departmental and operational decision making. Second, ensuring the identifying, organizing, and executing oral history interviews with DAF personnel

regarding timely departmental and operational subject matter. Third, planning, organizing, and executing any historical services assigned by the Director or Deputy Director of AFHRA.

A2.2.7. The Research Division (AFHRA/RS) responds to official and unofficial requests for historical information and provides field support to DAFHMP personnel, supports visiting patrons, fulfills duplication orders for historic materials within the collection, safeguards and preserves collection materials, posts approved data and historic materials on AFHRA's websites, oversees Research, Stacks, and Circulation Teams.

A2.2.8. The Information Technology Division (AFHRA/IT) is responsible for providing policy and guidance for planning, acquiring, managing, and operating personal computers and related equipment at the Air Force Historical Research Agency (AFHRA). It establishes local procedures for posting and reviewing content on the AFHRA web sites. Collects and maintains information protected by the Privacy Act of 1974 authorized by 5 USC. 552a, *The Privacy Act of 1974* (as amended). System of records notice (SORN) F084 AFHRA A, *Air Force Historical Research Agency System of Records*, applies. Ensure that all records created as a result of processes prescribed in this publication are maintained in accordance with AFMAN 33-363, *Management of Records,* and disposed of in accordance with the Air Force Records Disposition Schedule (RDS).